

Jake Rayner

UX & Product Design Lead

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Professional Summary

I'm a UX and product designer with over 10 years' experience working on digital products across a range of industries such as automotive, e-commerce, fintech and online gaming, including previous roles at Bentley Motors and Aston Martin Lagonda.

For the past three years I've led UX at Debenhams Group, setting up the UX function after the Debenhams acquisition and scaling it across all 21 brands within the group, designing industry-leading experiences whilst optimising for technical synergies and high-velocity delivery in a fast-paced industry.

Experience

Debenhams Group · UX Designer

Aug 2023 – Present

- Defined and launched a new Debenhams UX function post-acquisition, establishing design processes, principles and a cross-functional operating model for the digital product and technology team.
- Grew the team from a single brand (Debenhams) into a Group-wide UX function covering 21 brands, including Debenhams, boohoo, boohooMAN, PrettyLittleThing, Karen Millen, Nasty Gal, Coast, Oasis, Warehouse, Dorothy Perkins, Burton and more.
- Became the single most senior point of contact for UX/UI across the business, setting UX direction and representing UX cross-functionally, coordinating priorities and requirements from different brands and departments across the Debenhams Group to define the UX roadmap and deliverables.
- Established a bi-weekly alignment forum with the e-commerce and creative leads from every brand in the group, covering design reviews, feedback and feature sign-off, alongside a monthly collaboration and innovation session focused on longer-term ideation.
- Built and scaled a unified design system for 21 brands whilst retaining individual brand identities, maintained by a team of two designers and adopted by 50+ developers across multiple locations.
- Built a layered token system (colour, typography, spacing, border radius and motion) that themes all 21 brands through a single brand toggle attribute on the front end. Shared component families, including buttons, inputs, product cards and PLP, PDP, bag and checkout kits, plus a 130+ icon library, are skinned per brand from one source with no manual overrides required both in design and in front end development.
- Cut design and delivery timelines for new features across all brands from months to days, while migrating more brands from the group onto a single unified tech stack and improving output quality and operational efficiency with small, lean design and development teams.
- Led the rapid design, prototyping and development of industry-leading features, including virtual try-on, visual search, AI powered e-commerce agents and recommendation capabilities, social-integrated shopping experiences and a new streamlined checkout.
- Supported the design and delivery of various third party ancillary purchase and delivery services such as product personalisation, product insurance, In-Post and Evri click and collect, SEEL delivery protection and extended returns.
- Led WCAG and ADA accessibility audits and remediation across group brands, collaborating with the legal department and helping the business avoid payouts from attempted US accessibility litigation.
- Developed an AI-assisted workflow supporting the end-to-end design process (discovery, benchmarking, prototyping and validation) using Claude, Claude Code and Figma MCP connections to enable rapid, high-fidelity prototyping. Design variants and iterations, built and tested in hours rather than weeks, as real, tangible experiences rather than flat designs. Beyond being a design deliverable, built on the same technologies as the live product (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React and React Native), these prototypes also helped to validate technical feasibility, speeding up delivery across design and engineering.
- Drove a continuous group-wide CRO programme of 100+ A/B tests over three years, run per project across the group's brands, measuring conversion rate, AOV, revenue per user and checkout completion to statistical confidence. Some example tests included:
 - New Shop By Fit functionality (+11.7% conversion on Karen Millen)
 - AI-generated review summaries on PDP (+2.3% conversion and +1.5% revenue per user)
 - Bag product recommendation optimisations (+2.2% conversion on Debenhams)
 - Checkout address CTA redesign (+1.8% conversion)
 - Click & Collect checkout optimisations (collect conversion up from 3.5% to 4.1%, reducing supply chain costs)

Aston Martin Lagonda · Project (Lead) UX/UI Designer

2021 – July 2023

- Led a UX/UI team of 5 (two senior designers, two senior researchers and a motion graphics specialist), working alongside an internal product owner, EE feature owners, the interior design team, EE directors and C-suite senior leadership as well as several other third parties and suppliers to deliver next-gen infotainment and connected car experience.
- Worked on the full model-line refresh, starting with DB12 and continuing through the new Vantage, DBX707 and Valhalla, covering the end-to-end interior HMI: the central infotainment touchscreen, digital instrument cluster, steering wheel switchgear and centre console controls, plus the connected car experience across native iOS and Android apps. This included the new in-house infotainment system that replaced the previous Mercedes-Benz-sourced system.
- Led the planning and execution of customer research, prototyping, design and user validation testing within the R&D function, with a focus on HMI, native iOS and Android apps.
- Designed and validated information architecture, wireframes, interaction flows, prototypes and final UI across the connected car app, website, configurator and infotainment system through both online moderated and un-moderated usability studies as well as in-person focus groups at select dealer locations in the USA.
- Conceptualised, defined, built and maintained Aston Martin's first digital design system, derived from a new brand refresh, ensuring consistency across the in-car and mobile/desktop/wearable connected interfaces.
- Managed external agencies, suppliers, partners and contracted UX/UI specialists, acting as the bridge between internal strategy from the C-suite and senior leadership, and external execution and delivery.
- Ran monthly alignment sessions with the C-suite, internal department leads and external partners to review progress, gather feedback and estimate upcoming projects.
- Conducted benchmarking and competitor analysis, independently and with industry partners such as Screens and SBD Automotive, and presented research, design concepts and progress to the C-suite and senior leadership on a regular basis.
- Delivered HMI and connected car experience from initial concepts and designs to production-ready solutions in 18 months.
- Partnered with the digital, sales and marketing teams on the Aston Martin website and the new multi award-winning configurator (including 1st place in the Marketing category at Best of Consulting 2022), used by more than half of customers during their purchase journey and by dealers on the 35ft screen at Q New York, the brand's Park Avenue flagship. Together they captured customers up front, creating their Salesforce CRM profile and Aston Martin customer account from the first touchpoint.
- Worked with sales and marketing to carry that single profile end to end: once a customer spec'd and ordered, and the dealer activated their account, their order details and build slot information were already waiting in the native app. The same account then carried through to their connected HMI experience once the vehicle was delivered, creating a seamless end-to-end ownership experience rather than separate logins across siloed systems.

Bentley Motors · UX/UI Designer

2018 – 2021

- Supported the Digitalisation and Innovation team in the execution of Bentley's digital transformation.
- Designed, maintained and developed Bentley's first UX playbooks and design systems across internal and customer-facing native iOS and Android apps.
- Led UX/UI for Bentley's two core customer-facing apps, My Bentley and the Bentley network owners' app, delivering several new iterations and features that brought both in line with the brand guidelines and new UX playbook/design system.
- Worked with VW Group supplier Quartett Mobile on My Bentley, built on the same technology as the Porsche and Audi apps, running workshops at their Munich office to define shared functionality, identify where Bentley could differentiate, and test on their connected HMI rigs, in alignment with key stakeholders from EE and Sales & Marketing.
- Designed early concepts for the curation engine, digital assistants, rear seat entertainment (RSE) controls and infotainment functions, alongside a broad range of internal enterprise and B2B apps across native iOS and Android.
- Supported Bentley's senior leadership in defining the Beyond100 strategy and vision.
- Helped develop a new digital talent pipeline and recruited and mentored 18 digital apprentices, and worked with Manchester Metropolitan University to help establish the UK's first Digital UX degree apprenticeship, shaping the curriculum alongside other local employers such as the BBC.
- Collaborated with VW Group brands (Porsche, Lamborghini, Audi, SEAT, Skoda and more) on various projects and initiatives where group synergies aligned.

The Co-operative Bank · UX Designer

2017 – 2018

- Led UX/UI design for the bank's new iOS and Android mobile banking app, and website, working with marketing, brand, research and business-wide stakeholders.

bet365 · UX/UI Designer

2016 – 2017

- Helped transition bet365 from a graphic-focused web design team to a digital product UX/UI team during a period of industry transformation, introducing tools and processes that improved customer experience, satisfaction scores and revenue.
- Delivered features to 6 million daily active users across iOS, Android and web.

Barclays Mobile Banking · UX/UI Designer

2015 – 2016

- Helped transition Barclays' design from external partners to a new in-house UX/UI capability for Barclays Mobile Banking, Barclaycard and Pingit, building the first mobile design language and UI kit.
- Delivered features that supported growth from 3 million to 6.5+ million active mobile banking users in under 12 months.

Barclays Innovation Team · UX/UI Designer & Creative Consultant

2014 – 2015

- Designed early digital banking products and concepts across iOS, Android and web for Barclays and external partner organisations such as Childline and Microsoft (Windows Phone), alongside producing video, animation, print and digital creative work in a small in-house team.

Skills

Research and validation: discovery, moderated and unmoderated usability testing, focus groups and customer clinics, card sorting, tree testing, A/B testing and CRO, analytics and insight synthesis.

Experience design: information architecture, user flows, interaction models and UI design, automotive HMI physical and digital interfaces, native iOS and Android, responsive web, WCAG accessibility.

Systems and prototyping: multi-brand design systems and design tokens, component libraries, UX playbooks, high-fidelity and coded prototypes (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React).

AI-assisted design: end-to-end AI workflows with Claude, Claude Code and Figma MCP, from discovery and benchmarking to prototyping and validation.

Leadership and strategy: UX strategy and roadmaps, design operations and governance, workshop and forum facilitation, stakeholder management up to C-suite, team leadership and mentoring, agency management, agile delivery across rapid digital and long-cycle vehicle programmes.

Tools and Proficiencies

Figma, ProtoPie, Sketch, Illustrator, Photoshop, Premiere Pro, After Effects, Miro, Confluence, Jira, UserTesting, Maze, Claude, Claude Code

Education & Qualifications

Diploma: Professional Competence for IT and Telecoms Professionals (QCF)

A-Levels: Business Studies, Media Studies, Maths, Music